

Eating as healthily as you can will help you stay well. If you are pregnant or are planning to become pregnant, a healthy diet can also help your baby. This nutrition checklist is for women and girls. You can complete this nutrition checklist on your own, or with your health care provider. If you follow a special diet, answer "no" or "I don't know" to any question, or have an increased or decreased weight for your height, you may benefit from assessing your diet in more detail or getting support from a healthcare provider. The intention is that this document will be adapted to the context of the region in which it is being used.

1. Do you follow any special diets or food habits?

2a. Do you currently eat three or more servings of fruit or vegetables (dried, juice, frozen, tinned or fresh) each day? Yes/No

2b. Do you currently eat at least one serving of dairy products (milk/milky drinks or puddings, yoghurt, cheese) each day? Yes/No

2c. Do you currently eat at least one serving of wholegrain or "brown" versions of foods such as bread, rice, pasta, crackers, cereals, oats, millet or wheat each day? Yes/No

2d. Do you currently eat at least two or three servings of meat, poultry (chicken or turkey) or eggs each week? Yes/No

2e. Do you currently eat at least two or three servings of pulses, beans, peas, lentils, nuts or seeds each week? Yes/No

2f. Do you currently eat at least one serving of fish each week? Yes/No

2g. Do you currently limit eating packaged snacks, cakes, pastries, or sugar-sweetened drinks to less than five times a week? Yes/No

3. Do you currently take folic acid? Yes/No/I don't know

4. Do you currently get regular exposure to the sun on your face, arms and hands for at least 10-15 minutes a day? Yes/No/I don't know

5. Have you had a blood test for anaemia recently? This could be a blood test that looks at your blood count, haemoglobin (Hb) or iron levels. Yes/No/I don't know.

6a. What is your height? Please specify centimetres or inches:

6b. What is your weight? Please specify kilograms or Stones and pounds:

Additional information for the healthcare provider. This information does not replace the advice from a medical doctor, health care provider or dietitian. It is intended for educational and informational purposes only.

Q1 is to identify any usual dietary practice that limits intake of certain foods or food groups that may put someone at nutritional risk. A well planned special diet can meet all nutritional needs.

Q2 (a) is to assess intake of nutrients including antioxidants, micronutrients and fibre.

Q2 (b) is to assess intake of nutrients including vitamin B12, calcium, protein and iodine. If the individual answers “No” to this question, consider if calcium supplements are required.

Q2 (c) is to assess intake of nutrients including fibre, B vitamins and minerals. If answered “No”, it may suggest higher intake of processed carbohydrates.

Q2 (d) is to assess intake of nutrients including vitamin B12, iron and protein.

Q2 (e) is to assess intake of nutrients including protein, iron and fibre.

Q2 (f) is to assess intake of omega 3 / omega 6 fatty acids, vitamin D, protein, vitamin B12 and iodine.

Q2 (g) is to assess intake of saturated fat, sugar, salt and other factors when consuming a full diet. In certain circumstances, it may be advisable to consume these foods such as in cases of inadequate oral intake or weight loss.

Q3. If “No” or “I don’t know”, assess further, including if the individual has ever taken folic acid and advise a supplement if appropriate.

Q4. if the individual has little sun exposure, lives in a region with inadequate UV rays to maintain vitamin D levels via endogenous production, or has dark skin, consider vitamin D supplementation.

Q5. Is to identify anaemia. Cut offs for haemoglobin may vary depending on the region. If low, consider assessing iron, B12 or folate levels and or supplement as appropriate.

Q6. Use the height and weight to calculate body mass index (BMI). This is calculated by dividing the weight in kilograms by the squared height in metres. A healthy BMI is usually considered to be between 18.5–25 Kg/m², although this depends on age and geographical region. Measuring BMI is a rough guide to how healthy a weight is for a height. The BMI does not indicate body composition or metabolic health of fat and muscle. For individuals who are not pregnant, counsel on healthy weight as appropriate for the individual before conceiving. For pregnant individuals, provide indications for appropriate gestational weight gain according to pre-pregnancy BMI. This may vary according to local contexts.

Weight gain targets based on pre-pregnancy BMI (based on Institute of Medicine 2009 guidelines):

	Total (kg)	Per week
Underweight <18.5kg/m ²	12.5 - 18	0.51 (0.44 – 0.58kg)
Normal weight 18.5-24.9 kg/m ²	11.5 - 16	0.42 (0.35 – 0.50kg)
Overweight 25.0 –29.9kg/m ²	7-11.5	0.28 (0.23 – 0.33kg)
Obese >30kg/m ²	5-9	0.22 (0.17 – 0.27kg)

Additional information: Health care providers should consider any foods in their region which are considered unsafe for pregnancy. Healthcare providers should assess other potential unsafe aspects of lifestyle such as smoking, alcohol, recreational drug use, or lack of physical exercise.